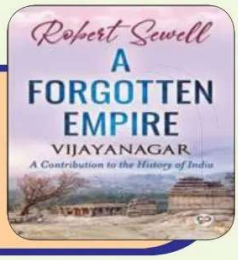
Chapter 5

VIJAYANAGARA – THE CITY OF VICTORY

"....A city that had merchants from Persia & Portugal crowding its shops, which displayed gold and gems as though they were common wares, a city whose sceptre was the law of the land till the point where land met sea."

- Robert Sewell



LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss about the rise of Vijayanagara Empire.
- Explain the greatness of king Krishnadevaraya
- Appreciate how culture, arts, architecture, literature flourished under the empire.
- Examine how the empire declined.

INTRODUCTION

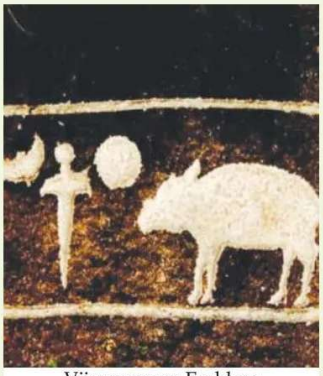
The south of Bharat was reeling under the onslaught of the invaders in the early 1300s. The Sangama brothers - **Harihara** and **Bukka** were administering and leading the northern parts of the Hoysala kingdom. They were captured by the invading forces of Muhammad bin Tughluq, converted to Islam, and sent to administer regions in present day Karnataka and Andhra as representatives of the Delhi Sultanate. Although Harihara and Bukka got converted to Islam, they were waiting for an opportunity to convert back to Hindu Dharma. The Hindu citizens of the area were also spirited to get away from the rule of the Delhi Sultanate. Harihara and Bukka saw a chance to revert to their original religion, Hinduism, and develop the regions they governed as independent rulers. Into the scene entered **Madhava Vidyaranya**, their spiritual mentor and guide. Vidyaranya enabled the Sangama brothers to set up their independent kingdom that laid the foundations for the Vijayanagara empire. Southern Bharat was able to release itself from the hold of the invaders.

HARES CHASING DOGS

Popular folklore talks about the choice of Hampi as the capital of the Vijayanagara empire. Harihara and Bukka were on an expedition when they see a hare being chased by a pack of dogs. Even as they see the hare run for its life, something unusual unfolds before them. The hare suddenly stops in its tracks. Turning around, the hare looks at the dogs and starts chasing them. The hunted turns into the hunter! Harihara and Bukka are astonished on seeing this and report this to their guru Swami Vidyaranya. On their guru's guidance, this area where they witnessed this incident was chosen as their capital city of Hampi.

SANGAMA DYNASTY

HARIHARA I


Vijayanagara Emblem

Harihara I was crowned king in 1336 CE in Hampi. The kingdom stretched from Dharwar and Badami in northern Karnataka to Nellore in the south-east.

The Vijayanagara empire emblem carried images of a varaha (boar), a sun, a moon and a sword. The sun and moon denote the long-lasting and illuminating nature of the kingdom. The sword signifies bravery and valour. The varaha (an avatar of Vishnu) signifies punishment of the wicked and protection of the world.



Harihara I ruled Hampi as a representative of Virupaksha, the God of Vijayanagara empire. Even the documents he signed were under the name of Shri Virupaksha

BUKKA I

Harihara I laid the foundation for an effective civil administration system that was taken over by Bukka I around 1356 CE. The outlying provinces of the kingdom were governed by his nephews under the supremacy of Bukka I. But Bukka's nephews thought of themselves as the final authority. Bukka I immediately sensed that this kind of ruling arrangement will lead to disintegration of the kingdom. He immediately appointed his sons to govern these outlying provinces and made them responsible for establishing his central authority. One of his sons, **Kumara Kampana**, was made governor of Mulbagal, a province in Karnataka. Kumara Kampana went on to become the key person to end the reign of the Madurai sultanate.



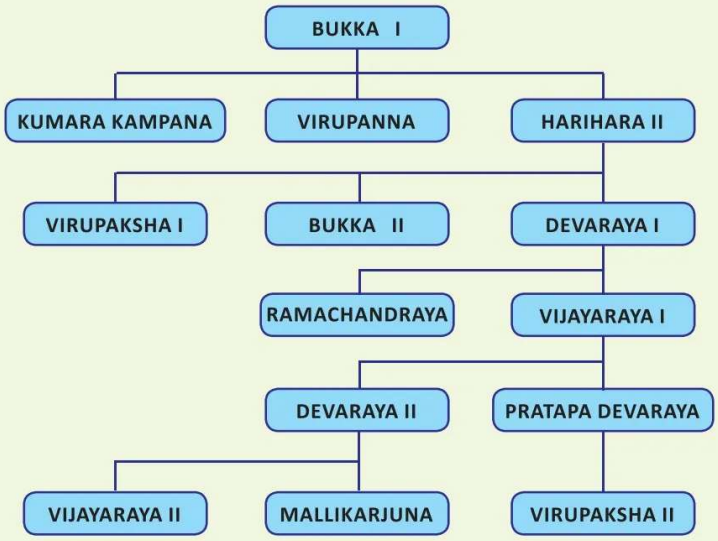
Vijayanagara Empire 1350 CE

KUMARA KAMPANA ENDS THE MADURAI SULTANATE

The Madurai region came under the grip of sultans like Jalaludin Khan in 1336 CE. The people of the region were tortured and killed indiscriminately. Hindu temples were razed to the ground. Ibn Batuta, the Moroccan Muslim traveler of that time details the atrocities of the Madurai sultanate. Kumara Kampana victoriously eradicated the Muslim presence at various centres in present-day Tamil Nadu. He freed Tamil Nadu and most of southern Bharat by slaying the sultan of Madurai in 1370 CE. The temples of Srirangam and Chidambaram suffered the worst during the rule of Muhammadans. Restoration of Srirangam, signaled the re-establishment of Hindu power in southern Bharat.

Regions of Arcot and Kondavidu came under the Vijayanagara flag. Bukka I successfully fought against the Bahmani sultans–once with Muhammad I and then with Mujahid. This brought Goa under the empire. The regions of Malabar and Sri Lanka were also won over by Bukka I. The rulers of these regions paid tribute to the Vijayanagara empire. The conquest of Madurai and beyond brought the regions all the way upto Rameshwaram under the Vijayanagara empire. Bukka I is considered the architect of the Vijayanagara empire.

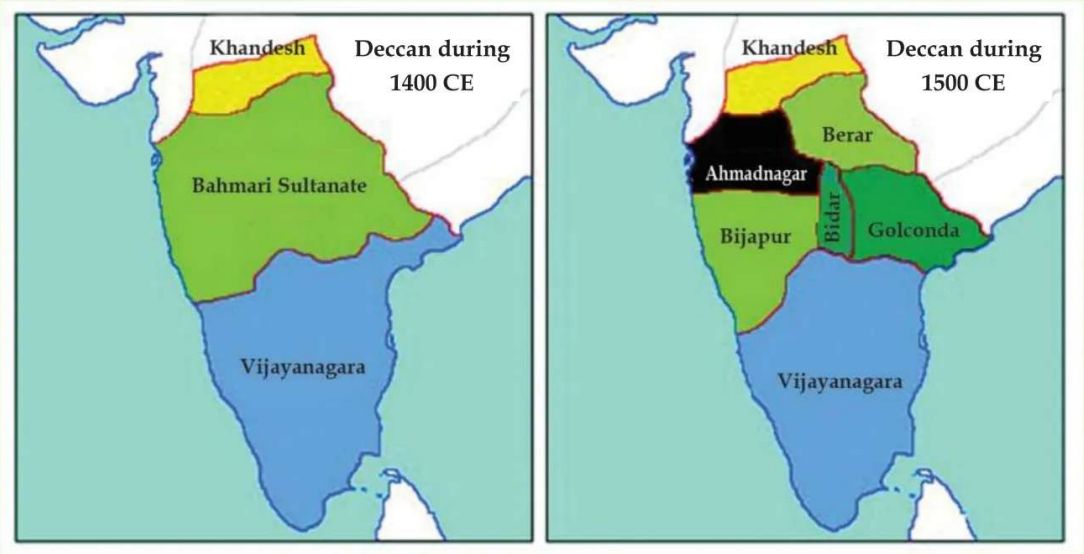
THE SANGAMA DYNASTY TREE AFTER BUKKA I

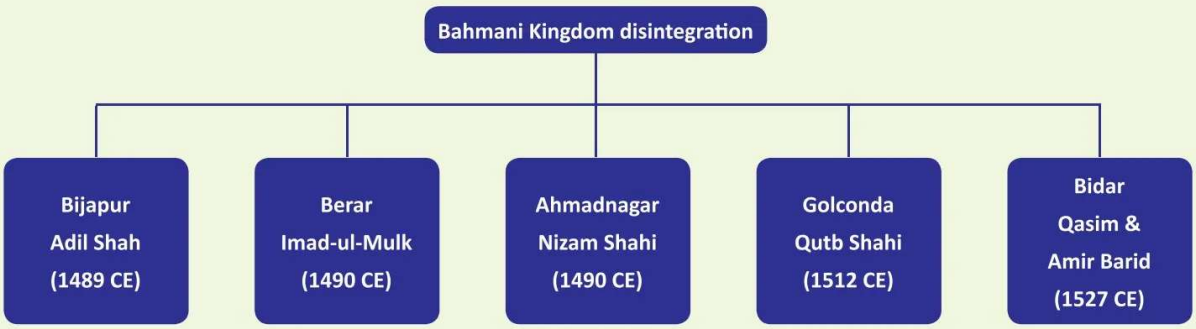


CHANGE IN POLITICAL FORTUNES

EMERGENCE AND DISINTEGRATION OF THE BAHMANI KINGDOM

Even as the Sangama dynasty was coming to a close due to weak and inefficient rulers, the Bahmani kingdom was also starting to break up. The rulers of the Bahmani kingdom believe that their roots were from Bahman, a mythological figure of greater Iran. Alauddin Hassan Bahman Shah revolted against the Delhi Sultan Muhammad bin Tughluq and established his own kingdom in the Deccan, marking the origin of the Bahmani kingdom. Muhammad Shah and his minister Muhammad Gawan had held the Bahmani kingdom together. However the death of Gawan quickened the disintegration. Yusuf Adil Khan, a slave under the Bahmani Sultan Muhammad Shah, had been appointed governor of Bijapur. When he saw the confusion in the kingdom he declared Bijapur as an independent kingdom under his rule. This marked the beginning of the Adil Shahi kingdom in 1489 CE. Thus, the Bahmani kingdom was broken up into 5 smaller kingdoms - Bijapur, Berar, Ahmadnagar, Golconda and Bidar.

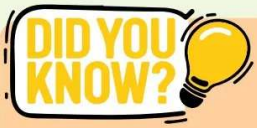




SALUVA AND TULUVA REIGN

With the Sangama rulers perishing, Vijayanagara came under the reign of the Saluvas followed by the Tuluvas. Saluva Narasimha , a brave general and governor, took over the responsibilities in 1485 CE. The achievements of Saluva Narasimha include the recapturing of the ports of Honnavar, Mangalore and Bhatkal from the Bahmanis. However, Saluva Narasimha suffered a major defeat at the hands of the Gajapati ruler of Odisha. This led to shrinkage of the Vijayanagara empire as many parts of coastal Andhra were lost to the Gajapatis.

The Saluvas were replaced by the Tuluvas in 1505 CE that laid the foundations for a revival of the Vijayanagara empire. 1509 CE saw the throne taken over by the great **Krishnadevaraya**.



Almeida, a viceroy of Portugal for the Indian coast, arrived in the Honnavar port around 1505 CE and was keen to establish trade links with Tuluva Narasa Nayaka. An Italian traveller Varthema praises Vijayanagara and records the presence of three layered walls for protection of the city. The Portuguese started engaging with Bharat – through both trade and military conquest.

KRISHNADEVARAYA, THE CREST JEWEL OF VIJAYANAGARA

The Vijayanagara empire saw its most famous ruler in 1509 CE, a king who never lost a war. The Ganga, Gajapati and Bahmani kingdoms shivered at the mere mention of his name. A king who was a scholar and patronized temples and poets. He was Krishnadevaraya.


Sri Krishnadevaraya

MILITARY CONQUESTS

Immediately after taking over the throne, Krishnadevaraya was involved in a major battle with the Bahmani sultan Mahmud Shah who had declared war against the Vijayanagara empire. The two sides met in Dony where Krishnadevaraya dealt a crushing blow to Mahmud. The Bahmani forces retreated to Kovelakonda and Krishnadevaraya's armies pursued them and forced another fight there and completely routed the Bahmani armies.

BATTLE OF RAICHUR

For over 200 years, the Vijayanagara and Bahmani rulers had been at war. A key fort, Raichur, was a constant source of many battles and it passed hands between the Vijayanagara and Bahmani kingdoms. Krishnadevaraya sought to capture Raichur and put an end to the feud. He met the armies of Bijapur sultan Ismail Adil Shah. Camped across the Krishna river was the army of Ismail Adil Shah. On 19 May 1520 the two forces met. While the initial advance of the Vijayanagara empire was furious, the canons of the Bijapur army created losses for the Vijayanagara army. This was a setback for Vijayanagara and as their

soldiers started falling back, a full scale retreat seemed imminent. Seeing this, Krishnadevaraya rallied all his soldiers from the front and charged at the Bijapur army. At great danger to his own life Raja Krishnadevaraya launched a counter-attack directing all his forces in a full scale frontal assault. The Bijapur army was driven to the river bank and were routed. Krishnadevaraya chased the Bijapur army beyond the river. Ismail Adil Shah managed to slip away. Raja Krishnadevaraya entered the Raichur fort victoriously. The victory was so resounding that the Bahmani sultans never dared to challenge the Vijayanagara empire during Raja Krishnadevaraya's rule.

BATTLE OF RAICHUR	
When?	20 May 1520
Where?	Raichur, Karnataka
Who were the combatants?	
Vijayanagara empire	Bijapur Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Krishnadevaraya	Ismail Adil Shah
Outcome : Bijapur Sultanate decimated	
SIGNIFICANCE : Bahmani sultans never challenged Vijayanagara again during the reign of Krishnadevaraya	

Krishnadevaraya conquered Raichur, Gulbarga and Bidar. After defeating the Bidar sultan, he placed Mahmud Shah as the ruler. This was to weaken his neighbouring rulers. Mahmud Shah was not liked by the Islamic rulers in the Deccan region and Krishnadevaraya ensured that there was disharmony among them.

THINK!!!

Why would Raja Krishnadevaraya place an enemy ruler on the throne after winning Bidar?



Extent of Vijayanagara empire under Raja Krishnadevaraya

A warrior general, Krishnadevaraya led his armies from the fro nt and won glorious victories. With the aid of an able minister in Saluva Thimmarasa, he maintained peace in the empire and ensured its prosperity. Krishnadevaraya is often referred to as a skilled and successful general, benevolent administrator, tolerant towards other religions and a lover of arts. He understood the need to engage with foreign forces like the Portuguese to ensure a stable kingdom.

Orange Learning
Your Knowledge Partner

DID YOU KNOW?

Krishnadevaraya had a massive army. It comprised of seven lakh infantry, twenty-two thousand cavalry and five hundred and fifty-one elephants ever prepared for war !!!

KRISHNADEVARAYA AND THE PORTUGUESE

The Portuguese were trying to establish forts on the West coast. To establish their presence in Bharat, they made many requests to Krishnadevaraya including asking for his help to invade Calicut. Krishnadevaraya refused that but allowed the Portuguese to build a fort at Bhatkal, a coastal trading town. In return, Krishnadevaraya was able to get a regular supply of hundreds of Arab and Persian horses that he inducted into his army.

THINK!!!

Was Krishnadevaraya correct in allowing the Portuguese to establish a trading post? Are there other examples where such an arrangement between nations have been done?

LIFE IN VIJAYANAGARA

HARNESSING WATER, A LIFE SOURCE

The regions in and around Hampi are rocky and arid. The Tungabhadra river is a key water source, but it is a rain-fed river and is not a perennial water source. How did the residents get water supplied to their farms, homes and palaces?

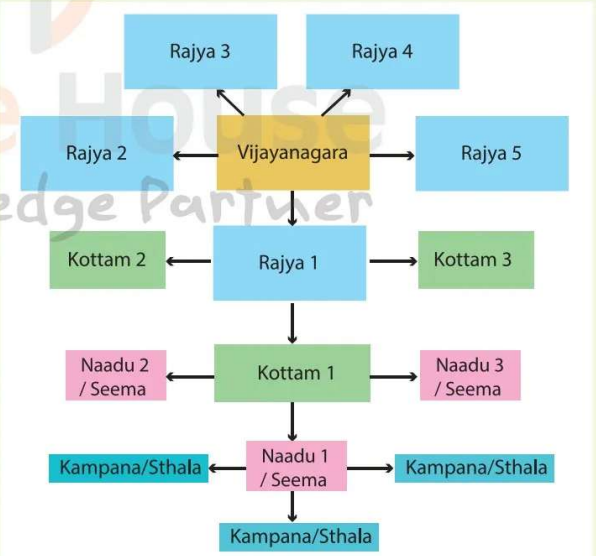

Aqueduct - built by Bukka

In 1345 CE Bukka constructed an Aqueduct to lift huge quantities of water from river Tungabhadra to nearby places. Deva Raya in 1410 CE built a dam across the Tungabhadra. He built a network of canals for irrigation. This ensured the agricultural prosperity of the region. To provide reliable drinking water supply to the people living in Vijayanagara, an extensive network of large canals interconnected with smaller canals took water to the homes of people. The world had not seen such water supply systems.

ADMINISTRATION

AN EFFICIENT ADMINISTRATION STRUCTURE

With the King at the top, Vijayanagara was administered with the help of a cabinet or Pradhana. This cabinet was led by a Prime Minister, the Mahapradhana. There were 72 departments (Niyogas) in a palace. To enable efficient administration, the empire was divided into five provinces (rajyas). Each province was further sub-divided into regions (Kottam), counties (Naadu) and municipalities (Sthala). The five rajyas had a governor and a commander to take care of administration and security. The governor of the rajyas were from the royal family who were familiar with the culture and the ways of the rajyas they ruled. This enabled efficient administration.



Vijayanagara administration structure

NAYAKA SYSTEM TO GOVERN

The Vijayanagara empire covered a large geography. Present day Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh were all under the Vijayanagara empire. The ruler gave away large tracts of land to **Nayakas** (or Nayaks), powerful generals or commanders. The Nayaks took care of the people and the regional needs. These included health management, irrigation, maintaining temples and all departments of a current day town or municipality. The Nayaks maintained a standing army to ensure the security of the region. Taxes were collected from the citizens of the region.

In return for the land grants given by the king, the Nayaks paid around half of the revenues collected as tribute to the central Vijayanagara rulers. They also sent their armies to assist the Vijayanagara rulers when required. Till around 1565 CE, the Nayaks were mostly military chiefs who governed and maintained an army.

THE MADURAI NAYAKS



Madurai Nayak governed region

Krishnadevaraya wanted to bring the Pandya kingdom under the Vijayanagara empire. In 1528 CE, Krishnadevaraya sent his popular general Nangama Nayaka to secure those regions. However, he started revolting against Krishnadevaraya. Krishnadevaraya sent Nangama's son Vishwanatha Nayak to quell the revolt.

Vishwanatha Nayak was successful in defeating his father and this was the start of the Madurai Nayak dynasty. Lands were cleared for cultivation, irrigation projects instituted, temples rebuilt and trade expanded. Most of the geography was divided into Palayams that were governed by local chiefs, known as Palayakarars (anglicized as Polygars).

Even after Vijayanagara fell, the Nayaka rulers continued in their respective areas. Some famous names in the Madurai Nayak dynasty include Thirumala Nayak and Rani Mangamma.

ECONOMY AND TRADE

The Vijayanagara empire was prosperous and its economy was renowned around the world. With a wide geographical spread of fertile lands and dry lands, agriculture thrived. Rice, wheat and sugarcane were grown in the fertile coastal belts. Pulses, cotton and millets were grown in the drier areas. Areca nut, betel and coconut were the main cash crops. Turmeric, cardamom, pepper and other spices were brought from the Western Ghats in present day Karnataka and sold in the cities.



Foreign Traders - Vijaya Vittala Temple Sculpture

The major sea-ports on both the west and east coast were conducive for trade. On the west coast, the ports of Honnavar, Mangalore, Bhaktal, Cannanore and Kochi were critical to trade. Machilipatnam on the east coast was one of the largest trading port and hub. Vijayanagara traded with China, Africa, Persia, Palestine, Java and the Far East and many more countries around the world.

Hampi was one of the most important economic and trading hubs. Accounts of foreign travellers, historians and other sources indicate that Hampi was an important



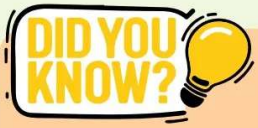
Remains of Hampi Marketplace

market for precious stones and gold. It is said that pearls, rubies, diamonds were sold in the open. Imagine large heaps of diamonds on the streets where merchants and customers haggled* on the rates.

Goods Exported :
Spices, Cotton
Jewelery
Precious stones
Perfumes
Iron, Steel
Tobacco

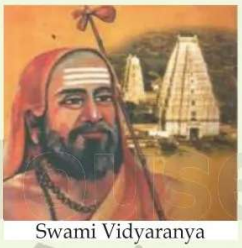


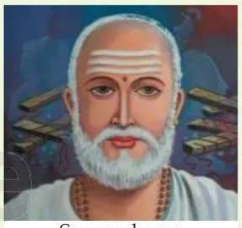
Goods Imported :
Mercury, Copper
Horses
Coral
Camphor
Luxury goods
Silk



Most farmers were given partial ownership of the land that they tended. Taxes were imposed when required and was calculated based on the extant of the land used and the necessity of the crop grown in the land. Confusing? Let us explore. The citizens of Vijayanagara loved perfumes. A key ingredient for making perfumes is rose petals. So, if a farmer cultivated rose in his/her land then the taxes would have been very low. Isn't that interesting?

RELIGION AND SOCIETY


Swami Vidyaranya


Sayanacharya

The Vijayanagara empire's society was characterized by openness and flexibility and Dharma assumed centre stage. Kanakadasa, a Kuruba who were typically shepherds or militiamen, was one of the most famous scholar and poet. From the potter community arose the great poetess Molla. Women were accorded a very high status in society and occupied important administrative and trade positions. Some of the most famous literary works of the time were composed by people like Ganga Devi (Madhura Vijayam) and Timmakka (Subhadra Parinayam). Vijayanagara rulers were firm devotees of Shiva and Vishnu. They were upholders of Hinduism. Sayanacharya, brother of Swami Vidyaranya was patronized by the Vijayanagara kings. He wrote commentaries on the four Vedas.

HARIDASA MOVEMENT - A SIGNIFICANT CONTRIBUTOR TO THE BHAKTI TRADITION


Swami Purandaradasa


Swami Kanakadasa

Knowledge of great philosophers like Sankara, Jnaneshwara, Madhvacharya were taken to masses through Dasa Sahitya or Literature of the devotees of the Lord. Lord Vitthala of Pandharpur was the primary deity worshipped by the Haridasas. Vyasatirtha, a famous saint in the Vijayanagara empire, was instrumental in creating the Haridasa movement. Some of the famous Haridasas (devotees) of this time include Purandaradasa and Kanakadasa. They helped inculcate Dharma among the masses and spread social awareness. Carnatic music was structured by the great Purandaradasa whose songs are sung in music concerts to this day. The Haridasa movement ensured that people were able to preserve their way of life and worship.

Haggle : Bargain

Bhakti movement helped people reconnect to their Dharmic roots and culture that had been erased due to Islamic invasions.

REFINEMENT IN CULTURE

ARCHITECTURE

The temples of Vijayanagara, the grand palaces, bustling markets, efficiently engineered water management systems, secured town planning and more indicate the advanced capabilities in the field of architecture in the Vijayanagara empire. The sculptors created poetry in stones like granite and soapstone.



Stone Chariot, Hampi



Virupaksha Temple, Hampi





Hazara Rama Temple: Scenes from Ramayana



Chennakesava Temple Murthi



Vidyashankara Temple

Grand temples like the Virupaksha temple and Chennakesava temple inspire us even today. The larger temples had a tall and grand gopuram called as Rayagopurams to indicate that it was built by the Vijayanagara kings. Krishnadevaraya commissioned some of the most famous Rayagopurams in the Chennakesava temple and Srisailam

temple. Temple carvings depicted scenes from the puranas, itihaasas and even daily incidents of those times. Stepwells have been discovered in Hampi that indicate influence of the Hoysalas in Vijayanagara architecture. The palaces were built with stone, wood, brick lime and finished with expensive metals and materials.

ARTS, LITERATURE AND MORE

Arts and literature flourished in the Vijayanagara empire. There were many poets, scholars and playwrights who composed in many languages for the learned and the masses. Works in Telugu, Kannada, Tamil and Sanskrit were composed during the rule of the Vijayanagara kings. Many rulers of Vijayanagara themselves were highly accomplished poets and scholars.

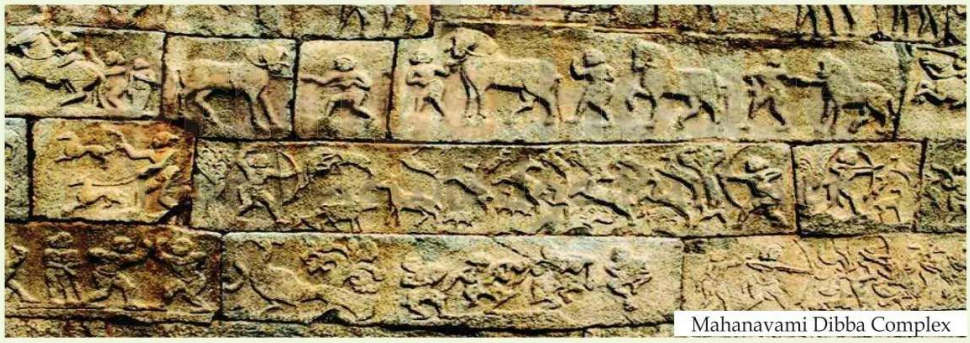
Raja Krishnadevaraya wrote many works including the Rasamanjari and Madalasa Charita in Sanskrit. A famous work in Telugu titled **Amuktamalyada** is his "master work or crowning achievement. Krishnadevaraya's court had eight reputed poets and scholars-the Ashta Diggajas.

DID YOU KNOW?

Tenali Ramakrishna, popularly known as Tenali Rama was one of the Ashta Diggajas. He was known for his superior intellect and humour. He was a great poet and composed works like Panduranga Mahatmyam

SPORTS AND PASTIME

Vijayanagara people were keen to display their skills in many sports. Wrestling, boxing, hunting and fencing were some of the sports that the citizens of Vijayanagara indulged in. Wrestling bouts were greatly enjoyed by the people and many women were also involved in these bouts. Duels with spears and many weapons were also a popular pastime. The panel in the Mahanavami Dibba complex in Hampi depicts women who are shown taming wild horses, wielding bows and spears and riding horses and elephants. Kabbadi, ball games and many other games are said to have been popular.



Mahanavami Dibba Complex

DID YOU KNOW?



Have you seen these statues of Raja Krishnadevaraya and his queens?

They are found at the famous Tirupati, Balaji temple.

Next time you visit the temple, make sure you look out for it!



Women Wrestling - Hampi

DECLINE OF VIJAYANAGARA

ALIYA RAMARAYA AND THE DECLINE OF THE VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

In 1529 CE, Krishnadevaraya died of illness when he was 58 years old. Achyutha Devaraya succeeded him. Many internal disturbances and external attacks were a feature of his reign where he lost Raichur and Mudgal to the Bijapur sultan. After his death in 1542 CE, there was some confusion in the succession but Aliya Ramaraya, the son-in-law of Krishnadevaraya, took over as regent till 1550 CE. Aliya Ramaraya then became king. For almost 15 years he ruled Vijayanagara during which time he inducted many people loyal to him in the army. He placed many Muslims in responsible positions within the army. During his reign, he constantly interfered in the politics of the states in the Deccan to keep them weak and to increase his power.

TALIKOTA AND ITS AFTERMATH

The sultans of Berar, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Bidar and Bijapur recognised the confusion being seeded by Aliya Ramaraya. They formed a coalition (except Bidar) and attacked Aliya Ramaraya in the Battle of Talikota in 1565 CE. The battle happened at present day Rakkasa-Tangadi which is southwest of Talikota. Aliya Ramaraya had prepared to ensure that the combined forces of the sultans do not cross the river Krishna. The Bahmani armies had identified some parts of the river that were unguarded. They pretended to attempt the river crossing at certain points that were guarded and failed at it. The Vijayanagara armies had their guard down with the initial success. However the Bahmani armies now pushed through the unguarded points to cross the river. Initially it appeared that Vijayanagara forces were winning but soon many of the Muslim generals in the Vijayanagara army, like the Gilani brothers who were appointed by Aliya Ramaraya, betrayed him. Tens of thousands of Muslim soldiers in the Vijayanagara army defected or deserted their side and helped the Bahmani armies. Aliya Ramaraya was captured and immediately beheaded. Seeing their dead king, the Vijayanagara army retreated. However, they couldn't get far as the pursuing Bahmani armies massacred the Vijayanagara forces.

One account of the war states that it took more than 12 days to count the dead bodies that lay between the battlefield and Hampi. The Bahmani forces then marched towards Hampi. They camped there for more than 6 months during which time they burned everything in their sight. All the wealth was plundered, temples and palaces demolished and anything within a 90 km radius was burned down. Grand and prosperous Hampi got referred to in Kannada as "Haalu" Hampi or "Ruined" Hampi.



BATTLE OF TALIKOTA

BATTLE OF TALIKOTA	
When?	January 1565 CE
Where?	Rakkasa-Tangadi
Who were the combatants?	
Vijayanagara	Deccan Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Aliya Ramaraya	Deccan sultans
Outcome : Defeat of Vijayanagara	
SIGNIFICANCE : Fall of the consolidated Vijayanagara empire.	

AN ASSESSMENT OF THE CAUSE OF THE DEFEAT AT TALIKOTA

When a civilization attains maturity and prosperity, it needs to be very careful to not become lazy and careless. Ramaraya became too comfortable when he thought he could manage the Bahmani sultans by creating divisions between them. However, they came together, bound by their common religious faith. The Vijayanagara empire was bound by Dharma and Aliya Ramaraya was inclusive enough to have many Muslims in his army. However, this proved to be a major factor in his loss at Talikota. The Bahmani sultans used the Muslims in Vijayanagara army to defect to their side. The Bahmani sultans fought amongst themselves. However, they were prepared to come together for the cause of their religion. Ramaraya thought

he was well prepared for war. However, he underestimated the enemy's collective power and motive. Will the future rulers of Bharat learn from these mistakes?

CONCLUSION

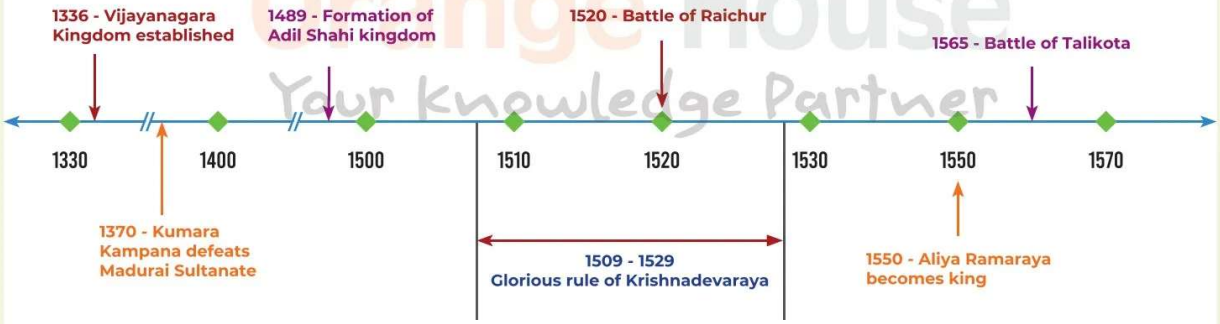
The contributions of the Vijayanagara empire to our nation and the world has been tremendous to say the least. It helped preserve the way of life of Bharat, especially in the south. This becomes more evident considering the mindless destruction of peoples lives, wealth and temples in the north by the Islamic invaders. But for the emergence and growth of Vijayanagara, the south would have met the same fate as that of the north. All aspects of our social and cultural life like dance, music, art forms, temple architecture, vedic worship etc would have crumbled if not for the rulers and citizens of the Vijayanagara empire. Prominent historian R.C.Majumdar summarizes, "…Modern Hindu India is indebted to the Vijayanagara kingdom in the south for having preserved the continuity of the culture and traditions, from the Vedic age downwards, which was in imminent danger of being altogether snapped. For it is impossible to deny that India was saved from this irretrievable disaster by the patronage of the rulers of Vijayanagara. While the (vedic) culture was submerged under the sea of Islam…it found its last refuge…at southern extremities. This plain truth is not realized by many historians."

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KEYWORDS

- Sangama Brothers
- Harihara and Bukka
- Swami Madhava Vidyaranya
- Bahmani Sultans
- Kumara Kampana
- Saluva and Tuluva
- Krishnadevaraya
- Battle of Raichur
- Nayaka system
- Stone chariot, Hampi
- Architecture
- Haridasa movement
- Ashta Diggajas
- Aliya Ramaraya
- Battle of Talikota

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



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QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Which of these was **NOT** a part of the Vijayanagara Empire.
   a) Saluva b) Sangama c) Gajapathi d) Tuluva
2. Look at the statements below and choose the right answer
   Statement A : Bahmani kingdom got broken up into 5 smaller kingdoms.
   Statement B : After Saluvas, the Vijayanagara empire came under the Sangamas.
   a) Both are True b) Both are False c) A is false but B is true d) A is true but B is false

3. Which of the following forces did the Vijayanagara kings NOT fight with?
   a) Gajapatis b) Madurai Sultanate c) Deccan Sultanates d) Portuguese
4. Which of the following statements is false
   a) Vidyaranya guided Harihara and Bukka b) Krishnadevaraya was a poet
   c) Saluva Narasimha was defeated by a Gajapati king d) Sultan of Bidar joined the Deccan sultanate against Aliya Ramaraya
5. In which of the following temples was not constructed by the Vijayanagara kings?
   a) Srisailam temple b) Raichur temple c) Chennakesava temple d) Virupaksha temple
6. Choose the right chronological order of events.
   A – Battle of Raichur B – Battle of Talikota
   C – Kumara Kampana's victory against Madurai Sultanate D - Formation of Bijapur Sultanate
   a) CDAB b) CABD c)BACD d)BDCA

MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Kumara Kampana	Deccan Sultanate
Krishnadevaraya	Gajapathis
Bukka I	Madurai Sultanate
Saluva Narasimha	Ismail Adil Shah
Aliya Ramaraya	Muhammad I

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Why did Harihara choose Hampi as the capital of his empire?
2. Who was Kumara Kampana? What was his contribution?
3. Vijayanagara kings were efficient in water resource management. Cite evidences to prove this.
4. What happened at Raichur in 1520? What was its importance?
5. Who were Madurai Nayaks?

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ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. What was the administrative system of the Vijayanagara empire?
2. Vijayanagara was a prosperous and thriving empire. Corroborate.
3. Krishnadevaraya was a master of both the sword and pen. Explain with examples.
4. Explain the Haridasa movement and its importance.
5. How did the Vijayanagara empire come to an end? Examine its causes.

CASE STUDY

The Vijayanagara empire's society was characterized by openness and flexibility and Dharma assumed centre stage. Kanakadasa, a Kuruba who were typically shepherds or militiamen, was one of the most famous scholar and poet. From the potter community arose the great poetess Molla. Women were accorded a very high status in society and occupied important administrative and trade positions. Some of the most famous literary works of the time were composed by people like Ganga Devi (Madhura Vijayam) and Timmakka (Subhadra Parinayam). Vijayanagara rulers were firm devotees of Shiva and Vishnu. They were upholders of Hinduism. Sayanacharya, brother of Swami Vidyaranya was patronized by the Vijayanagara kings. He wrote commentaries on the four Vedas.

a. Vijayanagara empire's society was characterized by openness and flexibility. Give an example.
b. Women enjoyed high social status. Give an example.

Give an example of how Vijayanagara kings patronized Hindu Dharma.